

EVIDENCE LOG

For Migraines (Headaches) VA Disability Claims

THE SMOKING GUN EVIDENCE

After years of navigating the VA claims process—as veterans ourselves—we discovered something that changes everything: **the single most powerful piece of evidence you can submit isn't officially part of a Fully Developed Claim.**

"No more convincing. Just corroboration."

When you walk into a C&P exam without this documentation, the examiner's job is to **investigate whether your condition exists and how severe it is.** They're playing detective. You're trying to convince them.

When you walk in WITH a properly completed Evidence Log, the dynamic completely shifts. The examiner's job becomes **corroborating what you've already documented.** They're not investigating—they're verifying. That's a fundamentally different exam.

HOW VA RATERS ACTUALLY EVALUATE YOUR CLAIM

Every VA disability rating—regardless of condition—is based on three core factors. Raters are trained to look for evidence of these specific elements:

FACTOR	WHAT IT MEANS	WHAT RATERS LOOK FOR
FREQUENCY	How often do your symptoms occur?	Daily? Weekly? Monthly? Document specific patterns.
SEVERITY	How intense are your symptoms when they occur?	Mild, moderate, severe? Must be "Prostrating" (needing to lie down).
FUNCTIONAL IMPACT	How do symptoms affect your daily life and ability to work?	Can't work? Can't tolerate light/noise? Nausea? Missed days?

Why This Evidence Log Works: The template you're about to use is specifically designed to capture all three factors in a format that's easy for raters to process. When a rater opens your file and sees 30 days of documented symptoms with frequency, severity, and functional impact clearly recorded, they don't have to guess or interpret. The evidence speaks for itself.

DO NOT FILE ANY CLAIM UNTIL THIS LOG IS COMPLETED AND INCLUDED WITH YOUR SUBMISSION

MIGRAINES: CONDITION-SPECIFIC GUIDANCE

Migraines are rated under **38 CFR § 4.124a, Diagnostic Code 8100**. The key term the VA uses is **"Prostrating."** This means the migraine is so severe you must stop all activity and rest (usually in a dark, quiet room).

What C&P Examiners Are Trained to Document:

- **Prostrating nature:** Do you have to lie down? Does it stop you from functioning?
- **Frequency:** How often do these prostrating attacks happen?
- **Duration:** How long do they last? (Hours? Days?)
- **Triggers:** Stress, light, sound, smells, food?
- **Symptoms:** Pulsating pain, nausea, vomiting, sensitivity to light (photophobia), sensitivity to sound (phonophobia), visual aura.
- **Economic Impact:** Missed work days, leaving early, lower productivity.

Migraine Rating Levels (What Your Log Should Demonstrate):

RATING	LEVEL OF IMPAIRMENT	SYMPTOMS TYPICALLY PRESENT
0%	Less frequent	With less frequent attacks.
10%	Characteristic prostrating attacks	Averaging one in 2 months over last several months.
30%	Characteristic prostrating attacks	Averaging one once a month over last several months.
50%	Very frequent completely prostrating and prolonged attacks	Productive of severe economic inadaptability.

How to Use the Evidence Log for Migraines:

When documenting, be specific about the "prostrating" nature. Did you have to lie down? Did you miss work?

Strong Entry Example: "Migraine started at 1000. Vision blurred (aura). Pain 8/10 pulsing on right side. Nausea. Had to leave work early (1100). Took medication, no relief. Laid in dark bedroom with blackout curtains from 1130 to 1800. Could not eat dinner. Vomited twice. Missed daughter's soccer game."

Weak Entry Example: "Headache today. Took Tylenol."

COMPLETED EXAMPLE: 7-DAY EVIDENCE LOG

Below is an example of a properly completed Evidence Log.

DATE	TIME	SYMPTOMS & SEVERITY	FUNCTIONAL IMPACT
Mon 1/6	0900- 1400	Sensitivity to office lights. Dull throbbing 4/10. Not prostrating.	Difficulty staring at screen. Took break every hour.
Tue 1/7	1500- EOD	PROSTRATING ATTACK. Triggered by stress. Pain 9/10. Vomiting.	Left work 2 hours early. Laid in dark room immediately. Wife handled kids.
Wed 1/8	All day	"Migraine Hangover" (Postdrome). Brain fog, fatigue. Pain 2/10.	Groggy at work. 50% productivity. Avoided bright lights.
Thu 1/9	-	No symptoms.	Normal function.
Fri 1/10	1800- 2200	Pulsing pain 6/10. Nausea.	Cancelled dinner plans. Rested on couch.
Sat 1/11	1000- EOD	PROSTRATING ATTACK. Aura started 0945. Pain 9/10.	Spent entire Saturday in bed. Could not drive. Missed chores.
Sun 1/12	All day	Recovery. Sore neck. Fatigue.	Low energy. Stayed home.

YOUR EVIDENCE LOG: 30-DAY TEMPLATE

Instructions: Complete one row per day for at least 30 consecutive days.

VETERAN NAME: _____ **CLAIM #:** _____

CONDITION: Migraines (DC 8100) **START DATE:** _____

DATE	TIME	SYMPTOMS & SEVERITY (Pain level, aura, nausea, prostrating?)	FUNCTIONAL IMPACT (Missed work, laid down, cancelled plans?)
Day 1			
Day 2			
Day 3			
...			
Day 30			

Note: Print this page multiple times to cover 30 days.